

~ Improv/Clown/Guided Meditation Jam Structure ~

Structure for Jam (90 Mins long)

Raise hands on how much you know about Improv

5 fingers means you know a lot

1 means you're completely brand new to improv

Raise hands on how much you know about play

5 fingers means you know a lot

1 means your new to play

Opening Words (5:35pm - 5:37pm)

- **Kunal:** Improvisational theater is an unplanned, spontaneously and collaboratively created experience that exists only in the present moment. A moment that ends as quickly as it starts, like the flame on a match.
- **Kunal:** Improv at the Garden will be a series of Improv games and warm-ups that help us align with being present in the moment. It may culminate in a 10-minute montage where we can take what we learn in the warm-ups to create an experience that will never be made again.
- **Kunal:** Temperance Alley Garden is the perfect host; much like Improv Temperance exists in a temporary space, it may not exist forever, but that does not mean the stories it tells or the relationships it fosters are not meaningful. Both Improv and Temperance teach us to truly savor the moment, pay attention, actively listen, and most importantly, engage with each other.
- **Kristina:** Our goal today is to spend an hour being silly, creative, and connecting with new people. Stepping out of your comfort zone is a muscle. It can take time to loosen up and feel ready to make silly choices in front of new people. I love when I get the chance to put aside the parts of me that are really worried about functioning and acting "normal" and "adult", and get to step into the other weirder parts of myself. It's allowed to take time, or feel weird, or maybe feel a little uncertain. That is all part of the process of improv and for me, as weird as it feels at first, once I lean into it, it starts feeling really fun.
- If any choice we suggest starts to feel like too much or too daunting feel free to tap out by just stepping off to the side and stepping back in when you're ready. We want to provide you a space to challenge your comfort zone while also holding space for you to discern what choices feel good today.

Name Game (5) (5:37-5:42pm) Kunal

Relationships are important at the Garden, in the art of Neighboring and, in Play and how do relationships start? Getting to know each other's names

- Hey What's Up XYZ
 - Go in a circle when person says name..the group says "Hey What's Up NAME"

Facilitated/Guided Conversation 5:42-5:52pm What does Play mean to us?

Key ideas:

- Play is the source of breaking down barriers, learning, and connection
- Viola Spolin social worker turned theater guru created Improv originally called theater games to help inner city youth in diverse Chicago find commonality and get to know each other
- "Improv puts you in contact with another person in a way you're not usually in contact with people. You really look at them and observe what they are going through, which is the beginning of empathy" - Alan Alda from Viola Spolin Inventing Improv Documentary
- The garden itself invites us to be neighborly. It's an accessible third space that people can stumble upon. Let's enjoy each other's company and nurture old and new relationships through this play!

Body Warm Up/Yoga: (5:52-6:02pm)

Now to wake up our bodies and attune ourselves to the space with a bit of yoga!

- Feel the ground beneath your feet, let each of your toes root yourself to the ground, connected to this beautiful space and earth like the mulberry trees sprinkled throughout
- Enjoy the air on this warm spring day and start to take deeper breaths
- Let's get close to the ground like our little rat friends that scurry around on table top position
- Now we'll enter into a cow position and drop your belly low to the ground.
- Now hunch your shoulders and chin to chest to go into cat pose and give your best MEOWS

- When you're ready, take a deep breath, drop the belly, enter into the cow pose and take a moment to look at the other cows around the pasture. If there is one that catches your eye take a moment to look at them
- When you feel inclined give them a deep an amorous MoOOOOOoooOOo
- Now take yourself back to the table-top and enter into a low squat, imagine yourself in a beautiful piece of nature and look at the people around you as you're about to take the biggest shit of your life. When you're ready let it all out in a powerful SCREAM AHHHHHHHHHHUGH

Walk around the space as an emotion (Kristina) 6:02-6:18

Okay so this exercise is all about connecting to different emotions and embodying how they show up in our physical experience. I'm going to have you picture 3 different emotions with different scenarios- the first one you choose, the second one is anger and the third one is joy. I am going to give you a few specifics about the emotion and then you get to decide how you portray it.

Okay another emotion. I want you to think about yourself as a teenager. Picture them. I want you to think about them on a day when nothing was going their way. How would you walk around the space as them? Before we start, think about what characteristics they would be walking with. Are they rolling their eyes, what are their hands doing, do they have a lot of energy or very little? Okay let's walk!

Okay nice. Final one: Let's come back together. Now, I want you to close your eyes, take a breath, and picture you but when you were really young if you can conjure that image or as far back you can go. If you can, picture yourself having the best day. How would this version of yourself walk on this day? Okay open your eyes, let's walk around the space like them.

For this last one, I'll have us close our eyes for a few breaths if you feel comfy or just look down at the grass and think of either an emotion you were feeling recently or an interesting feeling to embody. What form does that feeling take? Does it scurry on all fours? Does it slink around? Does it run. For some of you it might pop up quickly (stressed from work) or (happy from getting some sunshine), for others you might not be able to identify it as quickly.

Let's walk around the garden with that feeling in mind.

The next set of group games are focused on building a sense of community and camaraderie with each other much like how Temperance does with people in the *DMV*

Mind Meld (5) 6:18-6:23pm) Kunal

- People in the circle stick their fingers up and go into the circle as groups of two folks try to get closer to the same word.
- **Intention: Build group mind and a deeper connection with each other as a community**

Alien, Tiger, Cow (6) (6:23-6:29pm) Kunal

- Each person picks a character and on the count of three the group unveils the character
 - Alien puts two hands on their hand and says BEEP BEEP
 - The tiger makes a claw motion and says RAWR
 - The cow put two hands on belly and says MOOOO
- This warm up helps people practice characters
- **Intentions: Feel a sense of group mind**

Tree Nut Squirrel (6) (6:29-6:35pm) Kunal

- This warm up helps people get into characters
- **Intentions: Embrace silliness as well as embody characters**

If there's time:

The next game will be us flexing some of the muscles we've been working on staying in character and listening to each other

Freeze Tag or Hitchhiker or collaborative group game (10) (6:35 - 6:47pm) Kristina

Intention: Flex our improv muscles and perform some scenes together

Note for this game: Try not to talk at the same time as each other. A big part of this game is listening while ALSO aligning with the energy of the other people in the car.

1. Place four chairs on stage to represent four seats in a car. Four students start in the car and they are going somewhere.
2. A "hitchhiker" stands up and puts their thumb out. The hitchhiker has a very strong characteristic, such as enormous sneezes, extremely old age, annoyed business person, etc.
3. One of the passengers will say "look, hitchhiker" and they will pull over to pick the hitchhiker up.
4. The hitchhiker enters the front passenger seat and the other students rotate around clockwise. The driver gets out of the car.

5. As soon as the hitchhiker enters the car, all the passengers and driver take on the hitchhiker's characteristics immediately and to the extreme.
6. They continue dialogue until new hitchhiker comes on.
7. We will call "scene" and then we'll line up another hitchhiker.

Thoughts on ending here if we run out of time?

Lastly, let's take the guardrails off and do some Improv

Give it a try to do a montage (6:47-7:00pm)

- Highlight basic montage rules
 - No touches to head or bathing suit areas
 - 80/20 rule: don't touch someone unless they give you permission. I.E if you reach your hand out let them decide if they want to hold it

Edits (Give an example of each edit)

- A wipe ends the scene that's when another two can come out and join the center stage
- A tag is when someone touches your shoulder that's when you leave and another person comes out. The person who stays in the scene plays as the same character
- We'll do a quick example

Zen Count (5) **BONUS Kunal**

- The group attempts a count down from 20 to 0, where one person says each line